

BRAND

STRATEGY + IDENTITY STANDARDS

Version 1.1 / August 2026

BRAND IDEA

A life with purpose. A place that feels like home.

Built from the public Circle of Life identity, mission, services, community portfolio and language already in market - then elevated into a scalable masterbrand system.



Our Family Caring for Yours

The brand is not "senior care." It is life, protected.

Circle of Life already owns unusually strong emotional territory: dignity, purpose, meaning, value, joy, peace, security, hope and wonder. The system below turns those beliefs into a disciplined brand.

EXECUTIVE THESIS

Circle of Life should look and sound like the most human, assured and residential assisted-living family in North Florida - never institutional, never sentimental, never generic.

KEEP The family-first warmth, purpose-driven care, residential feel, North Florida roots, existing tree/circle equity and heritage line "Our Family Caring for Yours."	ELEVATE Consistency, sophistication, photography, typography, parent-brand endorsement, proof language, digital experience, accessibility and operational governance.
STOP Generic senior-living stock language, excessive exclamation, unsupported superiority claims, inconsistent facility naming, and visuals that imply frailty or institutional medicine.	OWN Purposeful aging in a place that feels like home - with families reassured by a capable, visible, local care organization.

What the public brand says today

The current website centers on a clear promise: residents should do more than merely exist; they should thrive. It describes friendly community environments in quiet residential locations, 24-hour care, daily activities, assistance with daily living and medications, full-service dining, housekeeping, laundry and respite care. The parent brand currently presents four communities: Homewood Lodge, Rising Oaks, Grande Cypress and Oakridge.

CURRENT MISSION - PRESERVE VERBATIM

Our commitment is to provide non-institutional community retirement living. We believe this commitment allows our residents to age in place with dignity, purpose, meaning, value, significance, love, joy, peace, security, hope, and wonder.

Strongest inherited equity

- "Our Family Caring for Yours"
- Non-institutional living
- Purpose and dignity
- Community + residential setting
- Local, relationship-based care
- Tree/circle visual symbolism

Current friction to solve

- Parent/facility identity is inconsistent
- Site language shifts between "facility," "community," and "assisted living"
- Visual system is not standardized
- Claims are sometimes broader than the proof shown
- Each facility can feel like a separate brand

The north star

PURPOSE Protect what makes life feel meaningful as people age: dignity, identity, connection, agency and belonging.	MISSION Provide non-institutional community retirement living that allows residents to age in place with dignity, purpose, meaning, value, significance, love, joy, peace, security, hope and wonder.
VISION - PROPOSED Be the most trusted family of purpose-driven assisted living communities in North Florida - known for care that feels personal, environments that feel residential and operations families can trust.	BRAND PROMISE - PROPOSED Every resident is known, valued, safe and connected.
EXPERIENCE STANDARD Warm enough to feel like family. Professional enough to inspire confidence. Consistent enough to earn trust.	CATEGORY DIFFERENCE Circle of Life is not selling a room. It is preserving a life rhythm, relationships and sense of purpose within a supported community.

One position. Different reasons to believe.

POSITIONING STATEMENT

For older adults and families who want support without surrendering the feeling of home, Circle of Life Communities is a North Florida family of assisted living communities built around purposeful, non-institutional living - combining attentive care, residential settings and a commitment to dignity at every stage.

RESIDENTS "I can still be myself here." Emphasize belonging, choice, comfort, relationships, activity and purpose.	ADULT CHILDREN + FAMILIES "I can trust the people and the place." Emphasize visibility, responsiveness, 24-hour support, dignity, safety and communication.
REFERRAL PARTNERS "This is a dependable transition." Emphasize fit, responsiveness, continuity, services, local access and professional coordination.	TEAM MEMBERS "My work has meaning." Emphasize purpose, standards, respect, training, teamwork and human connection.
COMMUNITY + REGULATORS "This operator is serious and accountable." Emphasize compliance, preparedness, stewardship, clarity and local commitment.	FUTURE PARTNERS "This is a disciplined operator with a distinctive care model." Emphasize multi-community consistency, operating maturity and scalable standards.

Five ideas every touchpoint must reinforce

1. DIGNITY IS NON-NEGOTIABLE Residents are adults with histories, preferences, relationships and agency. Care supports identity; it does not replace it.	2. PURPOSE MAKES LIFE FEEL WHOLE Daily life should contain meaning, participation, connection and things to look forward to - not merely supervision.
3. HOME, NOT INSTITUTION Residential scale, familiar routines, warm language and human spaces are central to the brand experience.	4. TRUST IS BUILT THROUGH CLARITY Families should know what to expect, who is responsible, how to reach someone and what happens next.
5. COMMUNITY IS PART OF CARE Family, neighbors, staff, local providers and fellow residents all contribute to belonging and wellbeing.	PROOF RULE Every marketing claim should connect to something observable: a service, routine, environment, credential, process, story or measurable practice.

Warm authority

HUMAN Write person-to-person. Use names, real moments and familiar language.	ASSURED Calm, specific and capable. Never frantic, inflated or defensive.
RESPECTFUL Speak to residents as adults. Never infantilize aging, disability or memory loss.	GROUNDLED Local, residential, practical and real. Avoid luxury clichés that do not match the lived experience.
HOPEFUL Show possibility and connection without pretending aging is effortless.	CLEAR Short sentences, plain language, visible next steps and no healthcare jargon unless necessary.

Tone by moment

Marketing + tours

Warm, inviting, sensory, optimistic, specific. “Come see what a good day can feel like.”

Incidents + hard conversations

Direct, compassionate, factual, calm. Lead with what happened, what is being done, who is involved and when the next update will come.

Say less. Mean more.

HERITAGE SIGNATURE LINE - RETAIN
Our Family Caring for Yours

MASTER BRAND IDEA A life with purpose. A place that feels like home.	FAMILY MESSAGE Care you can trust. A community they can call home.
RESIDENT MESSAGE Support for what you need. Space for who you are.	RECRUITING MESSAGE Do work that matters in a place where people matter.
REFERRAL MESSAGE A thoughtful next step for people who need support without an institutional feel.	COMMUNITY MESSAGE Local communities. Purposeful living. Professional care.

Message hierarchy

Lead with emotion and purpose. Follow with concrete proof. Close with an easy next step. Example: “She deserves more than a safe place. She deserves a place where she is known. Tour a Circle of Life community and meet the people who make every day feel personal.”

Words shape the experience

PREFER resident, family, community, suite/room, care team, team member, daily life, support, purpose, dignity, choice, belonging, home-like / residential	USE WITH CONTEXT facility (regulatory/legal), patient (only when clinically accurate), medical care, memory care, dementia, supervision, medication assistance
AVOID the elderly, old folks, inmates, placement, warehousing, “we treat them like children,” helpless, burdens, “the best of the best” without evidence	STYLE Sentence case. Plain English. Minimal exclamation points. Numerals for hours/phone numbers. Use “24-hour” as adjective. Use “assisted living community” externally where possible.
CLAIMS Do not imply skilled nursing, guaranteed outcomes, medical capabilities, safety guarantees or disease treatment unless the specific licensed service and evidence support the claim.	STORIES Get documented consent. Protect dignity. Tell the person’s life, not only their diagnosis or care needs.

One family. Distinct communities.

RECOMMENDED ARCHITECTURE
Circle of Life Communities is the masterbrand. Each facility keeps its established name, but every public touchpoint carries a consistent endorsement: "A Circle of Life Community."

MASTERBRAND Circle of Life Communities	ENDORSED COMMUNITY Homewood Lodge Assisted Living A Circle of Life Community
ENDORSED COMMUNITY Rising Oaks Assisted Living A Circle of Life Community	ENDORSED COMMUNITY Grande Cypress Assisted Living A Circle of Life Community
ENDORSED COMMUNITY Oakridge Assisted Living A Circle of Life Community	PROGRAM NAMING Use descriptive program names under the facility/masterbrand: Respite Care, Family Resources, Memory Support, Dining, Activities. Avoid creating unnecessary mini-brands.

Rule

The facility name may lead locally; the Circle of Life endorsement should always be visible. No facility should look unrelated to the parent organization.

Protect the equity already in market

The supplied identity confirms the official horizontal lockup: a stylized tree inside a circular frame, paired with the “Circle of Life” wordmark and the descriptor “Assisted Living Communities.” The approved heritage colors are a deep indigo and soft sunlight yellow. Do not recreate, retype, trace or redraw the artwork; production files should originate from the approved master artwork.

PRIMARY LOCKUP Official supplied composition: tree/circle mark + “Circle of Life” wordmark + “Assisted Living Communities” descriptor. Use for website header, covers, formal communications and signage.	SECONDARY LOCKUP No alternate lockup was supplied. Any horizontal, stacked, one-color or small-space variant must be derived from the approved vector master and formally added to the controlled asset library.
MARK ONLY The tree/circle symbol may be used alone only after an approved mark-only master is created from the vector artwork. Do not crop the supplied PNG to manufacture one.	CLEAR SPACE Provisional minimum clear space = the cap height of the “C” in Circle around all sides of the full lockup. Confirm geometry against the vector master before final production standards are frozen.
MINIMUM SIZE Provisional: 180 px wide digital / 1.5 in wide print for the full lockup. The supplied 300 px raster is suitable as a reference and for limited digital use, not as the master for large-format production.	DO NOT Stretch, recolor arbitrarily, add shadows, place on visually busy backgrounds, alter the tree/circle, retype the wordmark, rotate, outline, separate elements or build derivative files from screenshots.
PRODUCTION STATUS The supplied 300 × 86 transparent PNG confirms the official lockup, descriptor and heritage palette. Archive it as the approved raster reference. Before signage, vehicle graphics, embroidery, large-format print or new logo variants, obtain an SVG/EPS/AI/PDF vector master and reconcile trademark/legal ownership.	



11 / COLOR SYSTEM

Heritage indigo. Sunlight yellow. Residential support colors.

The supplied logo allows the two heritage brand colors to be sampled directly from the approved raster reference. Those exact raster values are now locked below. Warm Gold and the remaining tones are functional extensions for accessibility, environments and a broader operating system; they are not replacements for the two heritage logo colors.

Heritage Indigo #292560 Official logo primary - sampled from supplied asset	Sunlight Yellow #F4ED72 Official logo accent - sampled from supplied asset	Warm Gold #D7B84B Functional accent / stronger reproduction	Cypress #496F60 Nature / care / secondary actions
Sage #8CA38F Soft support / backgrounds	Warm Ivory #F7F4EC Primary warm canvas	Stone #D9D4C8 Rules / borders / neutral blocks	Charcoal #242A2C Body text / functional UI

Usage ratio

Recommended visual balance: 55% Warm Ivory/White, 25% Heritage Indigo/Charcoal, 10% Cypress/Sage, 10% Sunlight Yellow/Warm Gold. Sunlight Yellow is the heritage accent; Warm Gold is the stronger functional accent when contrast or reproduction requires it.

Accessibility rules

White on Heritage Indigo and White on Cypress provide strong normal-text contrast. Heritage Indigo or Charcoal should be used on Sunlight Yellow. Charcoal works well on Warm Gold, Sage, Ivory, Stone and White. Do not use white body text on Sunlight Yellow, Warm Gold or Sage. Buttons and links must meet WCAG AA contrast and never rely on color alone for meaning.

Modern enough for today. Warm enough for care.

RECOMMENDED FAMILY

Inter + Noto Serif Display

INTER - PRIMARY

Use Inter / Inter Display for navigation, headings, body copy, UI, signage, forms and operational documents. It is highly legible, modern and neutral enough to scale across every facility.

Suggested weights: Regular 400, Medium 500, Semibold 600, Bold 700.

NOTO SERIF DISPLAY - EDITORIAL ACCENT

Use sparingly for mission statements, resident stories, long-form editorial intros and emotional pull quotes. It adds humanity without making the system feel traditional or dated.

Suggested weights: Medium/Semibold; italic only for short editorial accents.

Type scale

Hero 48-64 px / 700. H1 36-44 / 700. H2 26-32 / 650-700. H3 20-24 / 600. Body 16-18 / 400. Small 14-15 / 400-500. Operational print body should generally be 10.5-12 pt, not smaller than 9.5 pt for resident/family materials.

Typography behaviors

Use sentence case, generous line-height, short line lengths and left alignment. Avoid all-caps paragraphs, ultra-light weights, cramped tracking, centered body copy and decorative scripts.

The circle becomes a system - without becoming a gimmick.



THE ORBIT

Use partial rings, arcs and circular crops as a secondary device representing continuity, connection and life stages. Keep them spacious and restrained.

THE HORIZON

Pair curves with grounded horizontal rules or blocks. The brand should feel stable, not whimsical.

THE FRAME

Use soft-radius image frames and cards. Corners should feel residential and approachable, not overly rounded or "app-like."

THE GRID

Use disciplined spacing. One strong focal point per composition. The emotional tone comes from people and words, not decorative clutter.

PATTERN RULE

Never place the ring pattern behind critical text. Use 5-15% tint for background applications.

MOTION RULE

Digital motion should be slow, subtle and purposeful: gentle fades, restrained reveals, no bouncing icons or playful animation.

Show real life, not a category stereotype.

PEOPLE FIRST Prioritize real residents, families and team members. Show eye contact, agency, conversation, participation and personality.	REAL ENVIRONMENTS Use actual courtyards, dining rooms, suites, porches, activities and surrounding North Florida settings.
DIRECTION Natural light, warm neutrals, honest skin tones, documentary moments. Photograph at resident eye level. Let rooms feel lived-in but cared for.	AVOID Hands-only aging clichés, staged hugs, over-smiling stock models, lonely silhouettes, wheelchairs as the subject, hospital-like imagery, heavy HDR and luxury-resort fiction.
CONSENT Use documented releases and respect resident/family preferences. Sensitive care moments should never become marketing simply because they are visually compelling.	ICONOGRAPHY Simple 2px outline icons, rounded joins, limited detail. Use Navy or Cypress. Do not mix multiple icon families.
PHOTO TEST If the person in the image looks like a prop instead of a person with a life, do not use the image.	

The website should feel like the care model

HOMEPAGE Lead with one human promise, not a carousel. Follow with proof: communities, services, family/resident stories, what a day feels like, and a clear tour CTA.	FACILITY PAGES Use a shared template with facility-specific personality: location, licensure, capacity when appropriate, services, room options, gallery, leadership, contact, map and tour CTA.
CTA SYSTEM Primary: Schedule a Tour. Secondary: Call Us. Tertiary: Explore Our Communities. Use one primary action per section.	FAMILY TRUST Prominently show how to reach a real person, visiting expectations, what happens after inquiry, and who will follow up.
ACCESSIBILITY WCAG AA, keyboard navigation, visible focus, 16px+ body text, meaningful alt text, descriptive link labels and no information hidden only in color.	CONTENT GOVERNANCE Dates on policies. Clear ownership. Remove stale notices. Every location page must use consistent current contact information and endorsement language.

Recommended hero copy

"A life with purpose. A place that feels like home." Supporting line: "Circle of Life Communities provides assisted living across North Florida with 24-hour support, residential settings and care centered on dignity, connection and the person behind every need."

Make every physical touchpoint feel related

BROCHURES Masterbrand cover; facility name endorsed inside. Lead with the resident/family story, then services and proof. Use large type and real photography.	BUSINESS CARDS Masterbrand on front; individual/facility details on reverse. Avoid four unrelated facility card designs.
SIGNAGE Facility name can lead; parent endorsement must be visible. High-contrast, large-letter wayfinding. Avoid low-contrast gold lettering for critical information.	NAME BADGES First name prominent; role secondary; Circle of Life endorsement visible. Make eye contact easier, not branding louder.
FAMILY FOLDERS A consistent welcome system: contacts, what to expect, visitation, billing basics, resident rights, key routines and where to ask questions.	OPERATIONAL FORMS Brand lightly. Clarity outranks marketing. Use Navy/Charcoal headers, generous white space, plain labels and consistent version dates.
ENVIRONMENTAL PRINCIPLE When a family walks into any Circle of Life community, the brand should feel familiar before they consciously notice the logo.	

Human stories with standards

Social content mix

- 40% resident/community life
- 20% family education
- 15% team/member stories
- 10% facility/environment
- 10% purpose/mission
- 5% direct promotion

Use captions that identify the moment and meaning. Avoid posting only event flyers or generic holiday graphics.

Recruiting system

Lead with purpose and professional standards together. Show real roles, real coworkers, schedule expectations, training and what good care looks like.

Message: “Do work that matters in a place where people matter.”

Content series

A GOOD DAY Small moments that show purpose: gardening, music, conversation, meals, crafts, visits, walks.	PEOPLE OF CIRCLE OF LIFE Resident and team profiles centered on identity, skills, memories and relationships.
FAMILY KNOW-HOW Plain-language answers to common assisted-living questions.	BEHIND THE CARE Preparedness, training, maintenance, meals and routines that quietly build trust.

A brand is a management system, not a PDF

BRAND OWNER Assign one executive owner with authority over master assets, approvals, messaging exceptions and vendor standards.	MASTER ASSET LIBRARY Logo vectors, color values, fonts, templates, photography releases, approved facility descriptors, boilerplate, social templates and signage files.
TEMPLATE FIRST Do not ask four facilities to “follow the guide” from scratch. Give them controlled templates for the 20 things they use most.	QUARTERLY AUDIT Website, social, recruiting posts, print, signage and active forms. Fix drift before it becomes a new local standard.
VENDOR RULE Printers, web vendors, sign companies and ad partners receive the same current asset kit and a one-page non-negotiables sheet.	VERSION CONTROL Every formal brand document carries version/date/owner. Retire obsolete logo files and templates rather than leaving them available.

90-day rollout

1. Days 1-15: archive the supplied raster logo reference; obtain the original vector master; approve exact logo variants, palette/type, naming architecture and master messaging.
2. Days 16-30: build controlled templates for digital, print, social, recruiting, email signature and facility endorsement.
3. Days 31-60: rebuild parent website information architecture and standardize all four facility pages/sites.
4. Days 61-75: photography capture at each community; replace stock imagery and create an approved photo library.
5. Days 76-90: signage/print audit, team rollout, vendor package, governance cadence and first brand compliance review.

The release gate

STRATEGY Does this reinforce dignity, purpose, home, trust or community - or is it generic senior-living content?	VOICE Would a family member hear a calm, capable human speaking? Is the language respectful and specific?
PROOF Can every meaningful claim be observed, documented or explained?	IDENTITY Correct logo file, clear space, approved colors, approved type, no ad-hoc facility branding?
ACCESSIBILITY Readable type, sufficient contrast, descriptive links/alt text, no color-only meaning, no tiny print?	CONSISTENCY Correct community naming, parent endorsement, current phone/email, current policy date/version?
DIGNITY Would we be comfortable showing this piece to the resident featured in it?	NEXT STEP Is the intended action obvious - schedule, call, visit, apply, refer, read, sign or respond?
RELEASE RULE If a piece fails dignity, accuracy, accessibility or identity integrity, it does not ship.	

What is observed vs. what is proposed

Observed / supplied source material

- Existing heritage line: "Our Family Caring for Yours"
- Mission language centered on non-institutional living, dignity, purpose, meaning, value, significance, love, joy, peace, security, hope and wonder
- Four communities currently presented: Homewood Lodge, Rising Oaks, Grande Cypress, Oakridge
- Services include 24-hour assisted living, daily living support, medication assistance/supervision, dining, housekeeping/laundry, daily activities and respite care
- Owner-supplied official lockup: tree/circle symbol + "Circle of Life" + "Assisted Living Communities"
- Heritage raster colors sampled directly from supplied logo: #292560 and #F4ED72

Proposed / systematized in this guide

- Positioning, purpose articulation, vision and brand promise
- Master messaging and audience framework
- Brand pillars and voice system
- Functional extension palette and typography
- Graphic/pattern system
- Parent/facility endorsement architecture
- Digital, print, environmental and social standards
- Governance, rollout and QA release gate

Sources reviewed

circleoflifecommunities.com (Home, About Us, Services, Community Features, Gallery, Visitation Policy); public Circle of Life Communities and facility listings from the Lake City-Columbia County Chamber of Commerce; Rising Oaks, Homewood Lodge and Grande Cypress public facility pages; and the owner-supplied official Circle of Life transparent PNG lockup. Reviewed/updated August 30, 2026.

FINALIZATION REQUIREMENT

This v1.1 now incorporates the owner-supplied official raster lockup and locks its sampled heritage colors. To make the identity legally and production definitive, obtain the approved vector master (SVG/EPS/AI/PDF), validate any trademark registrations, and create controlled one-color/reversed/mark-only variants before mass production or large-format use.